

STEP ONE: Template message

For starters, I open a note and write a succinct message about my project that highlights why it's exciting. I choose an audience to write it to. Best: a specific friend, so that the message I create doesn't feel too market-y

This message will be the rough template – or “blurb” – that I customize for the rest of my outreach

Blurbology

A lot of this process is coming up with a compelling blurb about your project, one that you modify across contexts.

First: Make it SHORT (making it exhaustively long is a rookie move – ppl can click through or do research if they want to know more).

Second: make sure it results in a clear call-to-action (eg "Apply now: [link]"). Only one call-to-action per blurb.

Third: Add sort of deadline so people prioritize taking the action in a reasonable amount of time

Fourth: If you have any sources of social proof, you can add them into the message. This could be prestige (“as featured in NYT!”) or number (“100 ppl have already signed up!”) Be tactful if you’re including these in a personal message though – social proof is often better suited for mass messages

Example 1: Class

Below is a message that I sent to 20 friends for one of my FractalU courses – Body, Mind, World. Most people who joined the course became friends and are still collaborating with me today¹

Hey Zoe, I'm about to co-run this joint investigation of body-mind systems that I think you'd be perfect for. It's kinda ambitious, covering everything from contact improv to butoh and exploring how they can be applied to the rest of life. Wanted to let you know before I start advertising tomorrow because we're keeping it small – probably just 8 spots. Wdyt? <https://fractalnyc.com/Body-Mind-World-A-Joint-Investigation-15358c7c50c946499f679018a08185e1>

This message worked well but had some notable weaknesses:

- (a) no deadline – this resulted in me needing to remind people
- (b) no social proof – I could have mentioned the other ppl that Zoe knew who had already signed up for the course

¹ I say this because one way to conquer the fear of outreach is to keep in mind how your project will benefit others

Example 2: Semester

Here was my semester announcement that was more for a mass audience (I now think it was a bit long, but it did the trick):

 **Join Fractal University's Spring Semester** FractalU is an experiment to create an archipelago campus, with classes, labs, clubs, and coworking distributed across NYC, from cozy living rooms to beautiful studio spaces. Our goal? To explore what it means to learn, do research, and create groundbreaking work as adults – in a new ecosystem working parallel to existing institutions. But really, we're just in it for the love of learning and doing hard work alongside friends.

We're thrilled to announce our second semester with courses like:

- Body, Mind, Work (I'm co-teaching this one)
- NYC Politics
- Foundations of Computing
- How to Live Near Your Friends
- Introduction to Painting
- Freestyle Rap

And more! Register for a class by April 1st:

<https://fractalnyc.com/Fractal-University-Spring-Semester-021bbc3a58cf4947b875579698cd1b99>

On the next page, you'll write your own blurb!



Exercise: Build Ur Blurb

Test blurbs

Anything you write below *doesn't count*, so go wild. It can be stream of consciousness, just get material on the page. *If you want Tyler to look over your blurb, give him a shout!*

Final blurb (this is the one you edit to actually use)